

The Best Places to Eat Green Curry

Krajok See moderate

Krajok See used to be a closely guarded secret in Phuket town. It is named for the antique colored glass panes (*krajok see*) in its windows, and aside from the impressive cuisine, regular customers are drawn by the cozy and friendly atmosphere, enhanced by wooden ceilings and candlelight. Nowadays the restaurant is so well known that reservations are a must, as there are only about eight tables and one sitting per night (the restaurant is not open for lunch). Apart from green curry, another dish to look for here is *kung sarong*, shrimp wrapped in vermicelli, fried, and served with a tangy dip. Be sure to bring cash, as credit cards are not accepted. After 10 PM, the tables are pushed against the wall, a DJ spins tunes, and everyone dances.

26 Takua Pa Road, Phuket town; open evenings only, Tue–Sun; +66 7621 7903

Also in Phuket

A more down-to-earth, no-frills version of green curry can be found at legendary **Roti Chao Fa (+66 7622 1771; inexpensive)**, run by local Muslim Thais for over 30 years on the southwestern outskirts of Phuket town. As the name suggests, the large open-air restaurant specializes in roti, the unleavened flatbread derived from India's paratha. Customers dip roti into any of several curries, including green curry, served from large stainless-steel cooking pots. Rice is also available.

Also in Thailand

In Bangkok, **Roti Mataba (www.roti-mataba.net; moderate)** serves green curry very much in the southern Thai style, with roti or rice, in a charming two-story shophouse overlooking Santichaiprakarn Park. It's famous for its many variations of *mataba* (stuffed *rotis*), offering sweet and savory fillings from curried chicken, fish, or beef to banana or condensed milk. You can also sample other classic Thai-Muslim dishes here, such as *matsaman*, a tasty Indian-style curry with potatoes and peanuts.

Around the World

On the other side of the world, in San Francisco, California, **Manora's Thai Cuisine (www.manorathai.com; inexpensive)** offers one of the more authentic versions of Thai green curry found in the city, and at a reasonable price. Here it is served with a choice of chicken, beef, pork, or shrimp, and comes with both eggplant and green beans.



Above Many colorful rows of Sino-Portuguese “shophouses,” which doubled as shops and homes, were built in Phuket in the 19th century

Left Thai green curry has a sweeter flavor and lighter texture than Indian curries; lime and lemongrass add refreshing citrus undertones